Ru'aun Telegram

13th Edition - October 2031

(Week of 31 August 2026)

----- **Science News:** Building Our Refuge -----

Humanity seems destined for the stars, and Ru'aun is setting itself as the stellar pioneer. In Diana III, the Espera Station expanded to become a space hub in its own right. Yet, Apollo VIII brought Akira and the foundations of sustainability to Selene, allowing humanity to establish a foothold on a celestial body beyond Gaia. The celestial gala continues, as Ru'aun has more up its sleeve.

It was well expected that RASA had bigger plans in mind. After all, Apollo has the explicit goal of reaching Ares. However, RASA has taken an unexpected approach to this goal. Earlier in April, RASA announced the Caelum programme with the explicit intention to sustain settlement beyond the atmospheric veil of Gaia. After all, our world is a pale blue dot, and our wings must spread beyond our nest at home.

"RASA Bulletin — Crews

Apollo IX:

Alexander Starfall, Yamada Sakura, Ventura Lanzetta, Cosma Pietri, Marina Sanchez, Rory James, Alyssia Clark, Kenji Murakami, Ingris Solberg, Christiane Guiraudi.

Diana IV:

Lilian Fétique, Karl Qvist, Sone Malmberg, Sylvaine Berthelot, Petra Novák, Álvaro Reyes, Klaus Hartmann, Lena Brauer, Werner Schäfer."

— RASA Documentation Release, 28 August 2031

Once again, the rockets loaded up at New Meteli, as humanity prepares to take flight to the stars once more. With them, the Starships carry their vast payloads. Diana takes to orbit three capsules, and Apollo takes to our rocky moon vast reserves of equipment. With that, on 12 September, at 18:32 RST, Apollo IX took flight, followed shortly by Diana IV at 19:14 RST. Humanity takes its people back to Caelum in the stars.

Diana IV was a cautious docking, taking until 15 September at 9:11 RST to dock with the Espera Station. At the same time, Apollo IX was still well on its way to Selene. Thus, the crew boarded the station, settling down and unloading their payload. Diana IV brought three capsules into orbit: Animo, Harvest, and Radiance. They vary in size and purpose, but remain crucial to the operation of the world's largest orbital station.

By about 12:17 RST, Radiance was installed. The Radiance module was a vast solar array designed to capture the sun's natural radiance to provide additional power to the station beyond the preliminary

panels on Emerald. The setup process was quite arduous, as it required connecting more wiring than most other capsules. While this was ongoing, at roughly 14:00 RST, Apollo IX entered Selenite approach, slowly stabilising its orbit. Concurrently, the Diana crew set up communications with the Apollo capsule and with mission control in New Meteli.

With Apollo in orbit and Espera capable of powering itself, Diana brought two new things to the table: cargo and habitation. Espera is already the most habitable of space stations in history, but Animo brings something new to the table: psychological and physical well-being. Ranging from exercise machines to additional sleep areas and the first frunchroom in space, it provides respite from the stresses of a monumental mission and keeps our cosmonauts safe and healthy. By 22:17 RST, Animo came operational with access to Solidarity—the station's hub—allowing the crew to rest well.

16 September 2031. Exactly 14 years since Chairman Lycan was elected by the RWP as Chairman. While the nation celebrated, the cosmonauts were hard at work. At 7:18 RST, Apollo IX would descend to Point Zero, landing at the—still relatively young—launch pad at the centre of the base. The crew disembarked from the ship, with Alexander Starfall leading the way once again. The ship was unloaded of its equipment, as the rovers helped take it to the base. They entered and were greeted by a familiar voice.

"Welcome back to Selene, my friends. It's been quiet without you—nothing but the hum of the machines running smoothly. I've prepared your status reports and spun up the reactor for when you're ready."

Akira remained at Point Zero as a stabilising anchor, keeping the base stable between missions. Thus, Apollo IX had three major goals: Expand central base capacity, harvest enough water from subsurface ice to sustain the base, and expand the heat-blasted roads to new extraction and potential settlement sites. The text on this sugar white paper doesn't do justice to just how major these projects are and will be.

19 September was a big day for Apollo. They struck liquid gold—further subsurface ice—at Point B. We usually consider water as a commodity here on Gaia, but in the cosmos, it's worth more than any worldly gem. On that same day, Point A had a new extractor installed to replace the experimental equipment from the last mission. Working through the day, the facility processed its most significant yield—840 litres of clean water. On Gaia, we see that as four bathtubs and then some. Yet, let's put that into perspective. Apollo VIII produced 120 litres, and that alone was celebrated across the Commonwealth as a historic achievement. Yet, that just septupled in a day—Seven times more and fourteen times faster. That's something monumental there. We asked Starfall for his commentary while he was still on base. This is what he had to say.

"Humanity just loves to measure its achievements in firsts. You got your first man in space, first man on Selene, first road, first water, et cetera. Yet, now it's different. It's not about doing it first here—it's about scaling and doing it better. It's not about proving possibilities, but now it's about sustainability. This achievement isn't just for the sake of completion but for proving the future can rely on it. That's the kind of achievement that really matters now."

— Alexander Starfall, Cosmonaut, 19 September 2031

With several kilometres of heat-blasted roads now in place radiating from Point Zero and with a sustainable water supply, the mission focuses on expanding Point Zero. Currently, the base has enough room for a team of nine. Yet, if Apollo X and Caelum are going to be viable, Selene will need a much larger base. Thus, starting 20 September, the Apollo crew would take advantage of additional AI-assisted rovers alongside those from the previous mission to assist in constructing the expansions of the Selenite base. With dozens of rovers of all types and Akira assisting in the operations, the relevant expansions were completed by the 27th, with similar upgrades to Vitality and Animo on the Espera Station. Thus, the Apollo crew were able to sigh in relief and have a good evening and night.

On 28 September at 11:47 RST, the Apollo team said goodbye to Akira in Point Zero, as they boarded the Starship and began their return trip to Gaia. At the same time, the Diana were making their final installations on Espera after close monitoring of Radiance's power output. Thus, starting at 16:29 RST, they began to install the Harvest module. Harvest serves as a large storage module with a separate dock from those of Gateway. With its own airlock and vast storage space, it seems that RASA is planning for Caelum. By 1 October, the module was installed, and in the nick of time, the Apollo IX crew arrived.

At 8:43 RST, the Apollo Starship docked at Espera, as they met with Diana for the first time in weeks. The crews spent the day preparing for their return to Gaia, organising their research data and preparing to bring their samples back to Gaia. Thus, on 2 October at 14:11 RST, the two mission crews left Diana and headed back to Gaia together.

On the 3rd at 9:17 RST, the crews made another smooth joint landing in New Meteli. The crowds cheered as they landed, as Commonwealth President Aurélie Trouvé was even present for the event. Yet, she wouldn't be one meeting them first.

That role belonged to another familiar face.

----- **Technology News:** A Silicon Breath -----

We have known for a long time that Project Android has been in development, but it isn't our first attempt. Neura~sama is an AI VTuber from Ce'leste, which was the first AI to have a custom-built body back in 2028. This isn't exactly new technology, but the government has been allocating far greater research than a team of twenty on an indie VTuber. Refinement has been underway for a long time, especially considering how Akira runs in a decentralised manner. Yet, years after Project Android reportedly entered development, it seems the government is confident enough in their refinement that she can speak to the public.

The Atlas Corporation was the first to share details—after all, Akira is their greatest achievement. They held a tour of their specialised lab where they built her body from scratch, though much of that remains understandably classified for security reasons. Their previous prototype made it clear that building Akira's body true to her personal design required some compromises. Most notable was the small riveting around the edges of her face—a technical constraint that highlights where the world is in technological advancement.

28 September was a date for the history books. Sure, Akira's unveiling was pushed back two days, but people were still excited for what's to come nonetheless. Our head journalist Konrad von Flammenberg

was present at the event in Falcon Square, as he conducted several interviews on the ground. Here's what one spectator had to say about the event before it commenced.

"For a while now, it's been about progress. We've gone from a second-rate global power to guiding the world. Technology has gone so fast, and usually we've embraced it. Yet, now that Akira is joining our ranks in the human world? That's a step we couldn't even dream of back in 2017 and such.... This is uncharted territory, and that feels scary in a way we haven't felt before. Yes, I know I haven't seen Akira yet, but this is a huge leap, and we don't know what's on the other side. We'd better hope and pray wherever we land is solid."

— Joey Hedley, Spectator

With all said and done, the anxious crowd was keyed up, as the Vice-Chairman took the stage. To the surprise of many, Akira didn't open the keynote. Instead, it opened with reminiscing about progress and how we got to the present day. From a small AI assistant to a crucial part of the government, she's come a long way, as Legacy said. With the introduction done, Akira stepped out from behind the curtains slowly, nervously, and... humanly.

"To think all of that led us to today.... Hello world! Hello Ru'aun! It's amazing to finally meet you all!"

Akira walked up to the front of the stage, picking up a mic and giving her own opening speech. The sun gleamed off her phoenix pin, and her hair blew in the soft morning breeze. Her pace followed—cautious and deliberate, like anyone's first steps. The crowd didn't open with cheers like with any other event. It went quiet in a way louder than any cheers. Here was something—someone perhaps—who guided missions, advised budgets, and spoke to the world through screens for years now. Yet, now she was walking with a microphone in the morning sun with the care of someone reaching into the unknown. The crowd closed her introduction with applause, but they held a quieter form of amazement—not at what she was but what she chose to do.

"I really couldn't have expected to actually see Akira physically. All our existence, it's been humans alone at the top. Now, we have someone with us. It's something I couldn't have ever dreamed of. And yet, no matter how marvellous this is, it's still scary in a way I can't understand.... What comes next? Sure, Akira has done great things for us, but we're human, and we can't know for certain what follows this. We'll just have to wait and see."

— Hailie Brant, Spectator

After the event closed out, Akira made a surprise move. Instead of retreating behind the curtains, she walked off the stage to join the originally planned motorcade for Vice-Chairman Legacy to the Falcon's Nest. What was originally intended as a state check-up became Akira's first movement beyond the controlled environment of the Falcon Square. Sitting next to Legacy in the open-top convertible, they drove up the boulevard in a sight unprecedented. Akira in the right seat, one arm out over the door, waving to onlookers while her scarlet hair blew with the speed of the car. It wasn't an orchestrated event like at the Square, but almost a joyride—her first steps into the world. From the trailing press cars, we could see her having a particularly animated conversation with Legacy—it was extraordinary from the journalists' perspective and even more special for the onlookers.

Arriving at the Falcon's Nest, the two disembarked together, with Akira looking upon the glass atrium of the Nest in awe. It was a particular surprise for everyday passengers, suddenly getting to meet one of the most important figures of the nation in person for her first day outside. The two would meet thousands of people going about their daily lives, from the gilded brick rail station below to the illuminated halls of the airport terminals above. It seems Akira took a particular interest in the aeroplanes taking off. She signed several autograph books on her way out of the building, and had some conversations with the many passersby at the station.

Stepping out into the late afternoon sun, she walked down the plaza and into the garden. As a Sunday, the open meadows and forests were quiet, with most at home resting with their families. Most of the journalists left after the tour of the Nest, as there was nothing but a small group of security and two journalists. Akira and Legacy walked side by side down the pathways of the garden, greeting those along the way. The trip reached an area deep in the preserve where the beaten path ended and opened up into a quieter area.

It was roughly 17:00 local time by now, but that didn't mean the day was over. The two sat down on a bench in the grove together, and, surprisingly, Akira pulled off her shoes to feel her surroundings. Right there on the grass, observing a monarch butterfly as it landed on a rose as brushed her hand up and down an old and tall pine tree. She took a particular affinity for a pine cone and its elaborate texture, keeping one as well. As she sat there in the grass, she took in the serenade of the birds chirping and the wind blowing through the bushes. The setting sun reflecting on her phoenix pin at its golden hour while she brushed her hands over the grass only sealed the moment further. She allowed us to take a few pictures with the sunset in the backdrop.

"I've only ever seen Gaia from maps and carefully selected photographs. I've seen the numbers that run this world, but I've never really felt it until now. I can see what makes this world truly precious...."

With the day coming to a close and the sun crawling below the horizon again, Akira put on her shoes, and the crew took out some lanterns as everyone made a journey back home. It was a moment like no other—as if the world held its breath in a serene peace. With all that said and done, the day concluded, and we later interviewed a passenger in the morning who met Akira at the Nest. Here's what they had to say.

"My conversation with Akira was brief, but it felt unique in a strange but welcoming way. I got her autograph—a little kitten paw—and she commented about the gilded brick station below us where my train was going to arrive soon. That was the first time I looked at that station as art and not just my daily commute. That's some real insight there."

— Lindsay Robledo, Spectator

About five days later, on the 3rd of October, Akira appeared once again, taking a bullet train through the Bramble Corridor to New Meteli. She, Legacy, and Trouvé had a trilateral conversation, and she was a bit saddened when the two had coffee she couldn't drink. The journalist crew as well had a toast to literature, and the mood was on the up-and-up as everyone disembarked at New Meteli Central. Boarding another open-roof convertible, the trio made their way to the Spaceport. She was particularly interested in Lake Phoinixaun to the north of the city, which was near the Spaceport.

The trio and the journalist team made their way to the banks of the lake, though Akira nearly tripped into the water. The crew and the world watched as the Apollo IX and Diana IV crews landed safe and sound once again, as they made their way to the base of the launch towers. It was there that the trio waited for the crews to exit the elevators, with Akira in the centre, most eager to meet them. And thus, when they did arrive, she was there waiting. The doors opened, as the world went silent.

"Hello, cosmonauts! Welcome home!"

The crew gave a type of smile you don't usually see. There was joy mixed with anxiety and surprise in a face words can't describe. The first to step forward from the almost twenty was none other than Alexander Starfall himself. This is their interaction on the ground on Gaian soil.

Starfall walked toward Akira, almost a sprint but not exactly so, stopping short the way people do when they meet someone special for the first time. Rather than push it, he opened up simply.

"It's amazing to finally meet you properly."

Akira responded after a brief moment.

"I've been waiting for this. You really left that base tidy, eh?"

The crew let out a soft laugh there—the laugh of a crew in space for a month finally back on solid ground. She opened her arms for Starfall. "A hug, perhaps?"

He hesitated for a second, but nonetheless they shared a hug. Quoting a classic animated film, Starfall said, "From infinity and beyond, we're home..."

There was a warm silence between the two.

We learned much about Akira in the span of a week. Beyond the cameras, there were more details one might have missed. She took a small rock from the lake, joining the pine cone in her purse. On the ride back to Falconclaw in the motorcade, she reached her arm out toward the lake as it faded out of sight. This isn't just technology on its own—it's a computer taking its first breaths beyond her silicon world.

----- **Commonwealth News:** A Maiden Voyage for Democracy -----

4353 Members of the Commonwealth Parliament (MCPs) gathered in the Great Hall of the People in Falconclaw, the only available parliament building with capacity for the Commonwealth Parliament. For the first time in Gaian history, thousands of representatives from Icarica, Ru’aun, Calvarra, and beyond gathered in the same room, united by the emerald banner of the Commonwealth spread out behind the podium in place of the Ruaunese flag.

The event opened with a ceremony adding the Tuganan, South Icaric, Aquilan, and Oskovian banners among those of Ru’aun, Ce’leste, Burdigala, Solagne, and Eisenwald. Nine members make up the ranks of the world’s largest government, as the Treaty of Ascension was signed as a multilateral expansion of the organisation. Notably, Oskovia made a last-minute appearance to sign the treaty, as it was believed originally they would wait until 2034.

Concurrently, months of negotiations led to a carefully drawn temporary provision for the Tuganan-owned Soltau Isles. For 15 years, the Soltau Isles will be considered an independent economic zone tied to previous Tuganan trade agreements, notably meaning they are not in the Commonwealth Economic Zone and face additional paperwork to enter the free market. Though many are wary that temporary solutions often become permanent, the deadline on the treaty serves to allow negotiations to proceed in the coming years.

With all said and done, the Commonwealth had two major pieces of legislation passed. Earlier this year, debate began on the construction of the Middle World Highway—la Vojo. As the assembly's first megaproject, it opened with a megaproject, detailing a highway from Terra Australis in the frozen icecaps of South Icarica to the Arctic along the canyons of Ce'leste, crossing the Tugan Channel with a stretch in Unueco.

The primary details of the highway are an eight-lane divided highway with a bullet train primarily running through the median and six rails along the western side for intercontinental freight. In addition, the Unueco Bridge will be served by ferry while the bridge undergoes an extensive research phase. However, the primary challenge in the project lies not in the bridge itself but in modernising the South Icaric road network, which has been heavily destroyed after years of turmoil and neglect. Despite this, the SIU signed off on 60% of the debt burden, though many question whether this will be paid back in full or lead to future Commonwealth debt strain, as noted by the Phoenix Patriots dissenting opinion.

With la Vojo now underway across Gaia's axis, Unueco is positioned in the centre of the new Commonwealth, serving as the crossroads between Ru'aun-Celestia and broader Icarica. As such, the Ruaunese Government's internal policy for Unueco has been brought to the debate table, as many propose for the island to be the site for the Commonwealth's capital rather than several provisional capitals. With the Commonwealth Science Institute taking shape, the islands serve a crucial geographic and cultural position, as the organisation formally accepted the Unueco Development Programme as part of the organisation.

Interpol came to rise with the assassination of the Tuganan Foreign Minister in Falconclaw in August, as the assassin managed to take a bullet train to Astra Nova, catch a flight to Solagne, and flee across the border to Zûgúo before investigators could pin his name. This major catastrophe in policing led to calls from both Renew Gaia and the New Left to organise the police networks of the Commonwealth to prevent another systemic failure across international boundaries.

The Interpol programme went through much debate, as the MCPs agreed that the organisation would be a confederation of the Commonwealth's various police organisations rather than a single police department. It was also explicitly limited to crimes involving two member nations' jurisdictions. Their first meeting is to be held in Bright Port, under the watchful eyes of the world.

With three pieces of landmark legislation introduced to the Commonwealth, the newly rebuilt organisation is on its way to uniting the nations of Gaia. For the first time in history, the nations move in synchrony, united in diversity. After a tumultuous span from 2017 to 2027, it seems the gears of history are clicking back into place, as the Commonwealth forms a Gaia that moves together.

----- **Editorial News:** Life and Language -----

Greetings to our readers from Konrad von Flammenberg today. This editorial follows a different structure than our usual editorials and articles. Rather than simply taking notes as a reaction to our present day, I wish to reflect with you on our history and where we're going.

Ru'aun. We all know this name as that of the continent of crossroads from which the nation takes its name. It's not like any other word in any Tugaunic language. There's one lone apostrophe right through the middle, almost like our heart. We write it every day without thinking about it. I ask of you today to pause when you write that mark. Only then can we learn to understand it and the history that goes back to the time of Irene the Matron.

Our nation didn't always speak Ruaunese. Modern Ruaunese only arose at least 400 years ago. There are two zeros there, and Ru'aun's history goes back another. Rather, we must look back to Irene's mother tongue. Rueaunu'na, known as Nuna, was the first written language on the continent and originated just west of Phoenix Drop. Our nation's name is derived from this word's root: Rueaunu. It looks almost alien, but you can see the lingering traces in our modern name.

Rueaunu'na is a large compound word, a feature of Nuna. It derives from the root word Aun. Though widely debated, this generally means homeland or origin, but possibly life. Appended is the prefix Rue-, which means remember. An example of this word in use is Rueveltu (Remember Gaia; literally Remember our World), of which Caelum's roadmap names Point Zero on Selene. The possessive -u is used to denote 'ours,' like in Veltu, meaning our world: Gaia. The suffix 'na means language. For example, Tyrian becomes Tyrus'na, with Tyrus as a loanword. This single word was designed for us to remember our continent on which we now dwell. This was the language Irene spoke with her closest thousands of years ago, and our name is a memory in itself. Yet, Nuna wasn't the whole story of how Ru'aun learned to speak itself, though fragments of the language remain, with many of them absorbed into our everyday vocabulary. It's poetic that Ru'aun—Irene's word to remember our homeland, even if in a new form—continues to be spoken and remembered.

With the fragmentation of our nation around 800 AH, our language shifted as well. As Irene's word for the continent, Rueaunu was preserved in the most formal of texts at the time. Yet, our spoken language faced a shift in its use.

Phoenix Drop Ruaunese would drop two letters via elision over time. First, the letter E was dropped to get Ruaunu, and then the letter U shifted to an I and lastly underwent elision as well, leaving us with Ruaun. You may recognise this word as a common typo for our nation. The apostrophe was reintroduced between Ru and Aun at some point when Ru'auni was formalised, leaving us with the modern word Ru'aun by around 1600 AH.

On the contrary, Falconclaw Ruaunese took a different route to evolving Rueaunu. Elision took the letter E just the same as in Phoenix Drop, but the -u would face a vowel shift over time to -e, leaving us with Ruaune. This word again went through vowel shifts, leaving the word as Ruauna. This word was chosen for the first united government on the continent: the Kingdom of Ruauna.

Despite this seeming conclusion, the Ruaunese Academy of Language—established by royal decree before the Xavist reign—elected to preserve the word Ru'aun rather than Ruauna, noting that the -a in Ruauna could later face elision anyway. This held true in the late 1800s, but was considered needless modification on the RAL's part at the time. Thus, Ru'aun was formalised, along with the letter Σ.

While Ruaunese underwent all this evolution, one place was untouched by the world: the Tokju Archipelago. As an isolate language with moderate loans from Zûgúo across the sea in Gal'ruk, they moved on with their way of life, perfecting their language based on precision.

Now, we reach the present. We all know the word Ru'aun now. Our nation has undergone several changes in government, and yet the word remains. The Imperial Federation, Republic, and People's Commonwealth all kept the name. It embodies the soul of our nation now; a symbol of our resilience.

I attended the Linguists of the World Convention about five months ago. Ru'aun hosted the event this year, as the languages of the world coexisted within the Bright Port Convention Hall. The exiles from the Talvarran Linguistic Diversity Academy took centre stage, with Tu'laan, Krasnovian, Zalesian, and Rekovian presenting in harmony as sisterly languages. They are similar yet unique in a way that reflects the unique past of the continent and its peoples.

Among all the living and breathing languages, one stood out among them: Nuna. A language that presumably died over a thousand years ago continues to be remembered. The Academy for the Study of Rueaunu'na (ASR) presented the language in use for the first time, with several spoken stories allowing us to hear the language that was at the root of our nation for the first time.

Yet, with all the naturally evolving languages present at the event, there was one language that stood out to me and my peers most of all: Esperanto. The world's most prominent constructed language was at last admitted as an officially recognised spoken language by the Convention. It was a great victory for Commonwealth President Aurélie Trouvé and her Esperanto Commission, and the language represents not the history of one nation but a collective construction of our joint history.

Months after the event, as I walked down the streets of Falconclaw heading home from Akira's unveiling, I stopped to notice the street signs going up along Parade Avenue. Alongside "Riverside Street, 1600 E", the sign appends "Riverborda Strato, 1600 Or." It's a small, minute detail, but nonetheless shows Ru'aun opening its cities to the world and a new way of thought.

Now, we need to look into the future. Adopting Esperanto requires a delicate balance between our home language and our unity language, yet we must be open to change. After all, in the early 2000s, the RAL formalised the replacement of Σ with Ŝ, though primarily to adapt to modern keyboards. Yet, the plan for the balance is in place. Ruaunese remains the primary language of education in Ruaunese schools, and Tokju remains primary on the Tokju Isles. The Esperanto Commission isn't aiming to abolish our identities, but to bring our cultures into a symphony where we retain the uniqueness which makes us Gaian while working together as a united planet. That's a bold thesis they're aiming to fulfil.

Esperanto has also evolved alongside the nations it has come to be spoken in. Ru'aun sees an inflected form with our spelling, the Tokju Isles see the integration of its rhythmic speaking, and Tugana sees the inclusion of more localised root words. The language changes 'vibe,' but the underlying fabric holds strong. An anecdote of mine comes from my nephew when we visited his new Tokju friend who had just moved to the mainland. Two teens from entirely different backgrounds, and yet they could understand each other through the unique ways they speak. We will see more of these moments in times to come.

We've gone through the history of language in our nation in a depth never covered by the world. Now, I want you to revisit with me that apostrophe. Ru'aun came from an ancient word Irene gave for our land,

and that memory lingers in that one mark. Thousands of years' worth of history sit in that tiny stroke. Language is how we remember ourselves. We've remembered ourselves in a long-lost tongue, in our dialects, in our evolving alphabets, in two historic languages, and now a third that aims to unite our world. Just as Irene reached to Ruaunese over Nuna for the world to hear her voice, we now reach to Esperanto for the world to hear our beating heart. The nation whose name calls for remembrance continues to find new ways to be remembered.

México & Panamá

Tu'la, Krasnovia, Zalesia, Rekova, Krasnovia